

096. Chapter 7 Verses 20-23

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 7.20

कामैस्तैस्तैर्हृतज्ञानाः प्रपद्यन्तेऽन्यदेवताः ।
तं तं नियममास्थाय प्रकृत्या नियताः स्वया ॥ 20 ॥

kāmais tais tair hṛita-jñānāḥ prapadyante 'nya-devatāḥ
taṁ taṁ niyamam āsthāya prakṛityā niyatāḥ svayā

kāmaiḥ—by material desires; **taiḥ taiḥ**—by various; **hṛita-jñānāḥ**—whose knowledge has been carried away; **prapadyante**—surrender; **anya**—to other; **devatāḥ**—celestial gods; **taṁ taṁ**—the various; **niyamam**—rules and regulations; **āsthāya**—following; **prakṛityā**—by nature; **niyatāḥ**—controlled; **svayā**—by their own

But those whose discrimination has been led astray by various desires resort to other deities, following diverse rituals, constrained by their own natures.

VERSE 7.21

yo yo yām yām tanum bhaktaḥ śhraddhayārchitum ichchhati
tasya tasyāchalām śhraddhām tām eva vidadhāmyaham

yaḥ yaḥ—whoever; yām yām—whichever; tanum—form; bhaktaḥ
—devotee; śhraddhayā—with faith; architum—to worship;
ichchhati—desires; tasya tasya—to him; achalām—steady;
śhraddhām—faith; tām—in that; eva—certainly; vidadhāmi—
bestow; aham—I

**Whatever may be the form a devotee seeks to worship with
faith— in that form alone I make his faith unwavering.**

VERSE 7.22

स तया श्रद्धया युक्तस्तस्याराधनमीहते ।
लभते च ततः कामान्मयैव विहितान् हि तान् ॥ 22 ॥

sa tayā śhraddhayā yuktas tasyārāadhanam īhate
labhate cha tataḥ kāmān mayaiva vihitān hi tāt

saḥ—he; **tayā**—with that; **śhraddhayā**—faith; **yuktaḥ**—endowed with; **tasya**—of that; **ārāadhanam**—worship; **īhate**—tries to engage in; **labhate**—obtains; **cha**—and; **tataḥ**—from that; **kāmān**—desires; **mayā**—by me; **eva**—alone; **vihitān**—granted; **hi**—certainly; **tāt**—those

Possessed of that faith, he worships that form and from it attains his desires, which are, in reality, granted by Me alone.

VERSE 7.23

अन्तवत्तु फलं तेषां तद्भवत्यल्पमेधसाम् ।
देवान्देवयजो यान्ति मद्भक्ता यान्ति मामपि ॥ 23 ॥

antavat tu phalam teṣhām tad bhavatyalpa-medhasām
devān deva-yajo yānti mad-bhaktā yānti mām api

anta-vat—perishable; **tu**—but; **phalam**—fruit; **teṣhām**—by them; **tat**—that; **bhavati**—is; **alpa-medhasām**—people of little understanding; **devān**—to the celestial gods; **deva-yajah**—the worshipers of the celestial gods; **yānti**—go; **mat**—my; **bhaktāḥ**—devotees; **yānti**—go; **mām**—to me; **api**—whereas

**But finite is the result gained by these men of small minds.
Those who worship the deities go to the deities; those who
worship Me come to Me.**